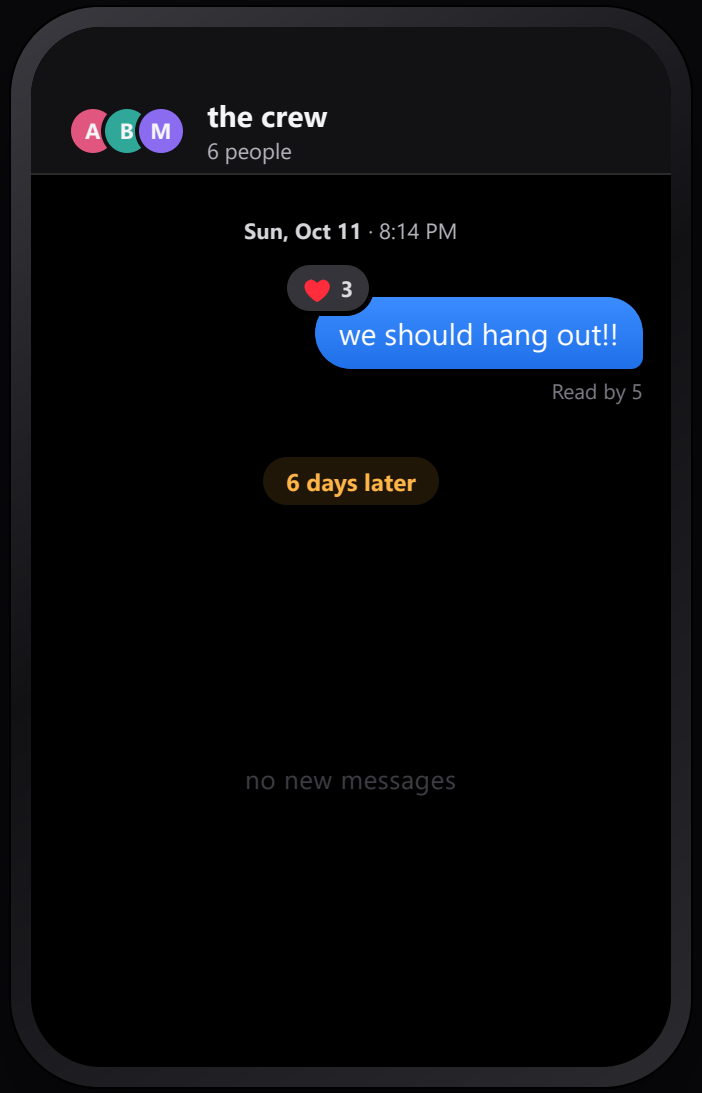


Otto

Otto is the friend who always makes the plan happen.
It never gets tired, and it forgets everything afterwards.

Team: {{TEAM}}

Built on Photon



THE PROBLEM

153 → 67

minutes a day with friends, in person · ages 15-24 · 2003 → 2019

Americans aged 15-24 spent 153 minutes a day with friends in person in 2003 — and 67 in 2019.

Source: Kannan & Veazie, SSM-Population Health 2023 (ATUS 2003-2020)

WHY IT KEEPS HAPPENING

01 **The organizer burns out.**

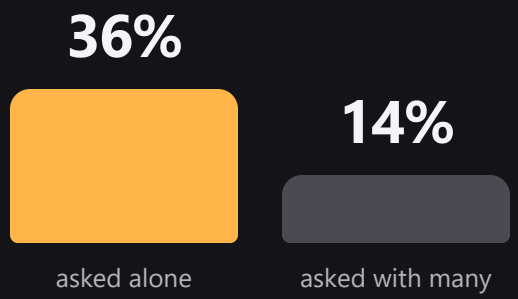
It's always the same person nudging, and they get tired of it.

02 **Silence reads as rejection.**

Nobody wants to be the one chasing the quiet friend.

03 **Tools leave the chat.**

Polls, calendar links and planning apps all send friends somewhere else.



36% vs 14% reply when one vs many are asked (Blair et al. 2005).

Blair, Thompson & Wuensch, Basic & Applied Social Psychology 27(2), 2005: email field experiment, 400 participants. Shown as a mechanism, not a group-chat statistic.

THE INSIGHT

The fix has to live in the chat you already have, and carry the social cost so no human has to.

> **Nobody keeps their social life in a calendar.** Otto never asks for one.



04 · VOTES, ANY WAY

Plain replies and hearts both count.

LIVE DEMO

Watch for three things.

1. Hearts and plain replies like “fri or sat works” both count as votes.
2. The quiet friend gets a short call, only because they opted in, and the group hears first.
3. Ask what it knows. Tell it to forget.

Video: phone mock-up of the flow. Call audio is simulated.

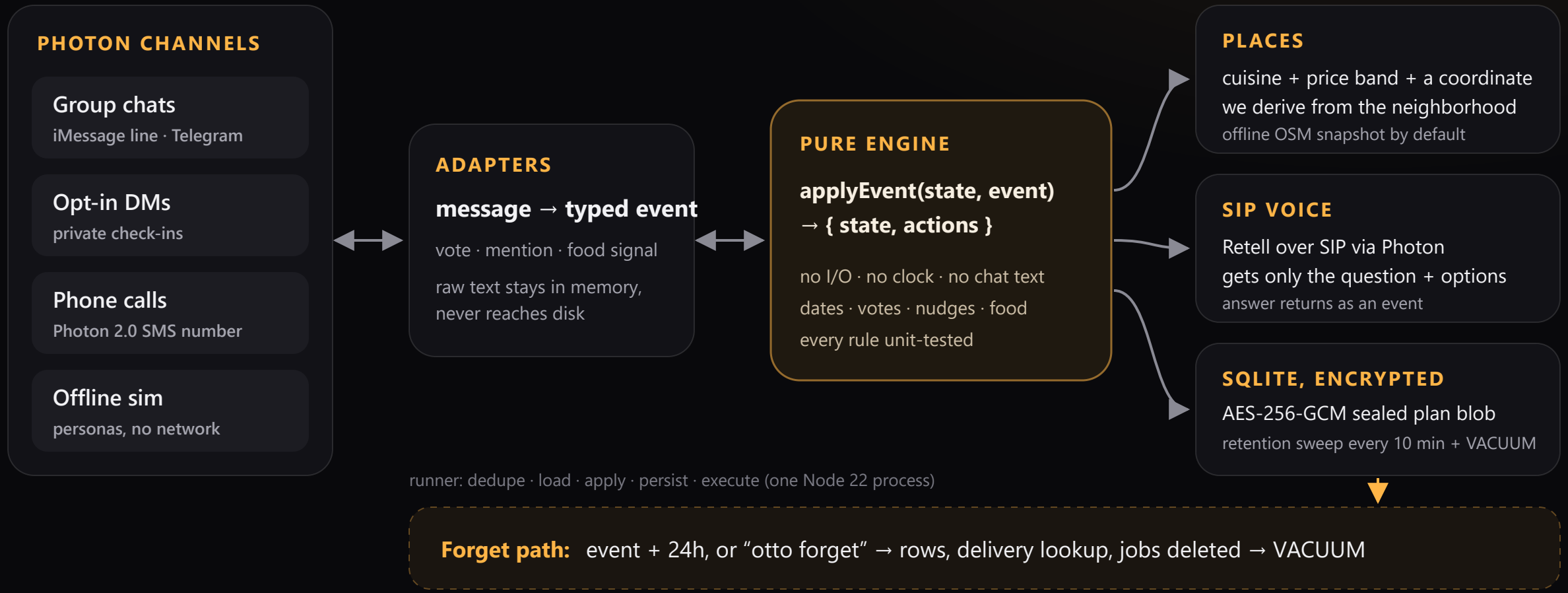
PRIVACY BY DESIGN

Ask it what it knows. Tell it to forget.

- It stores the plan, never the conversation: no table can hold message text.
- Everything personal is encrypted at rest, and logs scrub names and numbers.
- It never asks where you are: one typed neighborhood, kept with the plan.
- It deletes everything 24 hours after the event, or now with `otto forget`.
- DMs and calls only reach people who opted in, and the group is always told.

HOW IT WORKS

Thin adapters, a pure engine, and a store that forgets.



WHAT WE MEASURED & WHAT'S NEXT

Measured on labeled conversations, honest about the rest.

Date replies read correctly	98.5%
Right final date	10 / 10
Food-intent precision / recall	100% / 87.9%
Noise budget + quiet hours kept	10 / 10
Message text or numbers in logs / DB	0 / 0
Place matched cuisine + budget	3 / 4*

10 role-play group chats (183 labeled messages), written blind from our spec by a separate author that never saw the code · npm run eval · *the map has no Thai near Harvard Sq

What is simulated: the call audio in the demo video, and the chat personas in the offline simulator. Restaurants come from a bundled OpenStreetMap snapshot; prices are team estimates.

NEXT

1. **More channels**
   WhatsApp, RCS and SMS through Photon 2.0.
2. **Interactive iMessage cards**
   Tap-to-vote cards instead of option bubbles.
3. **Open-source release**
   So any group can audit exactly what Otto stores.